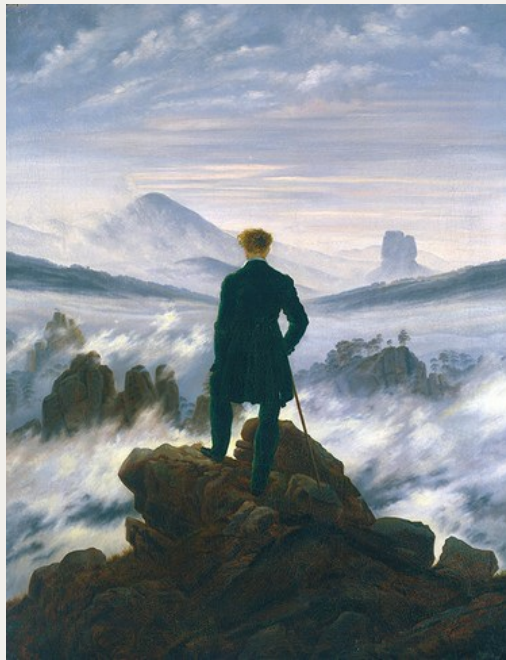


IN CONTEXT

German Romanticism

In the first half of the 19th century, German literature, visual art, and music were dominated by the Romantic movement, celebrating emotion, intuition, nature, and visionary genius in reaction to the rationalism of the 18th-century Enlightenment. Schumann was inspired by Romantic authors, such as the novelist Jean Paul (1763–1825), the poet Heinrich Heine (1797–1856), and the Gothic fantasy writer E.T.A. Hoffmann (1776–1822). His piano pieces *Kinderszenen* reflected the Romantic belief in childhood innocence and wonder.



WANDERER ABOVE THE SEA OF FOG, CASPAR DAVID FRIEDRICH, 1817

Born in 1810 in Zwickau, Saxony, Robert Schumann was encouraged in his interest in literature and music by his father, a bookseller and